

Answer Key: Challenges Stations

Grade 5 Writing

Learning target evidence

Target: I can identify how characters respond to challenges in a story.

Student wording may vary. Accept answers that accurately identify the challenge, response, and supporting details.

Station 1: Spot the Challenge

1. Maya cannot find the novel her group needs for the discussion.
2. Any two: she checks her backpack/area; remembers where she last used the book; tells her group; asks permission to check the art shelves; retrieves the book and returns.
3. **B.** She thinks about where the book might be and takes steps to find it.

Station 2: Put the Response in Order

1. Nia's bridge bends/fails during the test before holding as many books as she expected.
2. Correct order: **3** She adds support to the weak joints; **1** She looks closely at where the bridge failed; **4** She tests the bridge again; **2** She records the weak spot.
3. Accept: She studies the problem, improves the bridge, and tries again. / She responds by investigating, revising, and retesting.

Station 3: When the Plan Changes

1. **Challenge:** Heavy rain prevents the class from going outside for the garden presentation. **Response:** Luis uses photos from the week, draws a map of the garden, and uses those materials to present the observations indoors.
2. His response solves the problem because the photos and map let the class see and understand the garden observations without going outside.

Station 4: Same Challenge, Different Responses

Shared challenge: A fallen branch blocks the trail.

Character	How the character responds	Supporting detail
Marcus	He gives up on finding a solution and waits.	He sits on a rock, says the walk is probably over, and stops looking at the map.
Ava	She looks for another way to continue the walk.	She studies the map, notices a loop, and asks the teacher about using it.

2. Accept any accurate contrast, such as: Marcus waits and assumes the walk is over, while Ava searches for an alternate route and suggests it to the teacher.

Station 5: Match the Evidence

1. Mei forgets what to say / loses her place while giving her speech in front of the class.

2. Check: **She takes one slow breath.** Check: **She uses the large heading to remember her next idea.** Check: **She continues speaking.** Do not check the other three details.

3. Example: Mei responds to the challenge by taking a slow breath, using the heading on her note card, and continuing her speech.

Station 6: Explain the Response

1. Sample response: Sam's challenge is that the marble keeps rolling off the ramp before it reaches the target cup. He responds by testing the ramp several times and watching where the marble leaves the track. He tapes cardboard rails to the sides, then raises the top of the ramp when the marble moves too slowly. These changes help the marble stay on the ramp and reach the cup.

2. The underlined sentence should clearly state how Sam responds. Accept any sentence that accurately names his response, especially the sentence describing testing and revising the ramp.

Scoring note for Station 6

2 - Meets target	1 - Developing	0 - Not yet
Identifies the challenge, explains Sam's response, and uses at least two accurate details.	Identifies either the challenge or response correctly but explanation/evidence is incomplete.	Does not accurately identify the challenge or how Sam responds.